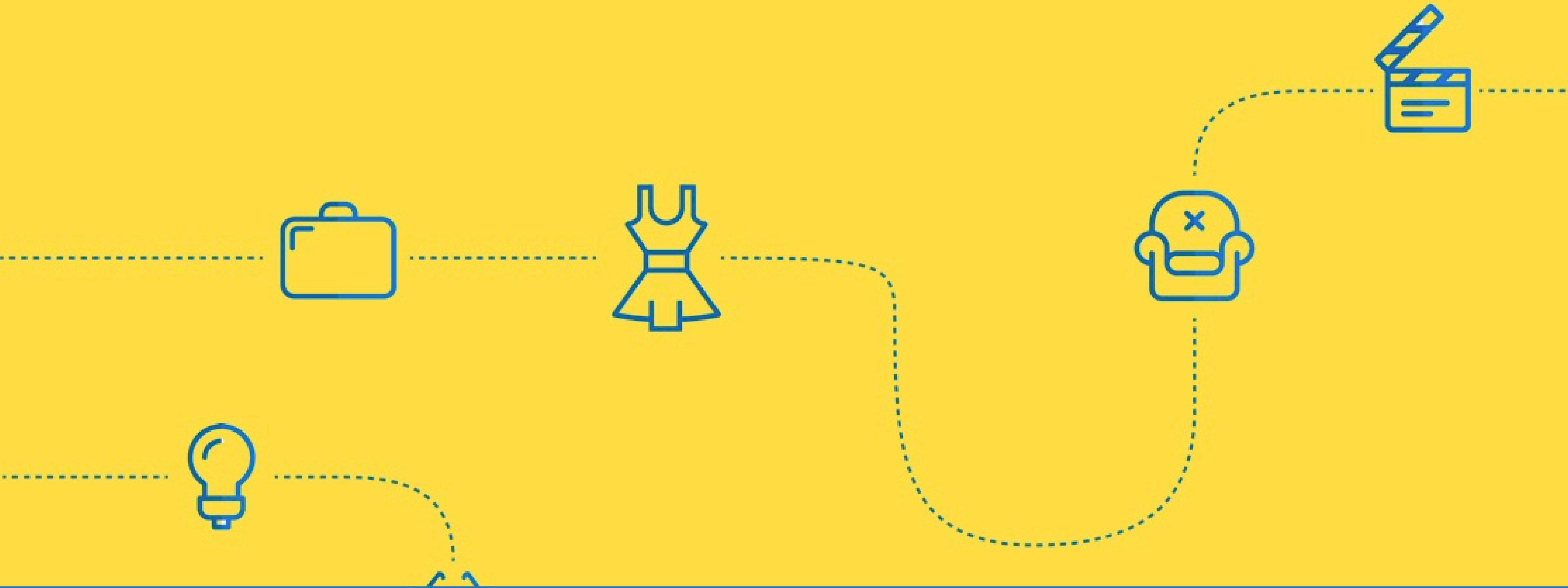




Reducing Refund Anxiety in Returns

Designing Trust, Not Just Timelines

Problem Statement

Improving the Return & Refund Experience on Flipkart

From Process Transparency to a Trust-Driven Guarantee

Returns are one of the most emotionally sensitive moments in the e-commerce journey.

While Flipkart provides tracking updates, QC notifications, and estimated refund timelines, users continue to experience:



Anxiety after pickup

Users lose both the product and sense of control once the item is picked up.



Uncertainty around approval

Refund approval feels like a black box with unclear criteria and timelines.

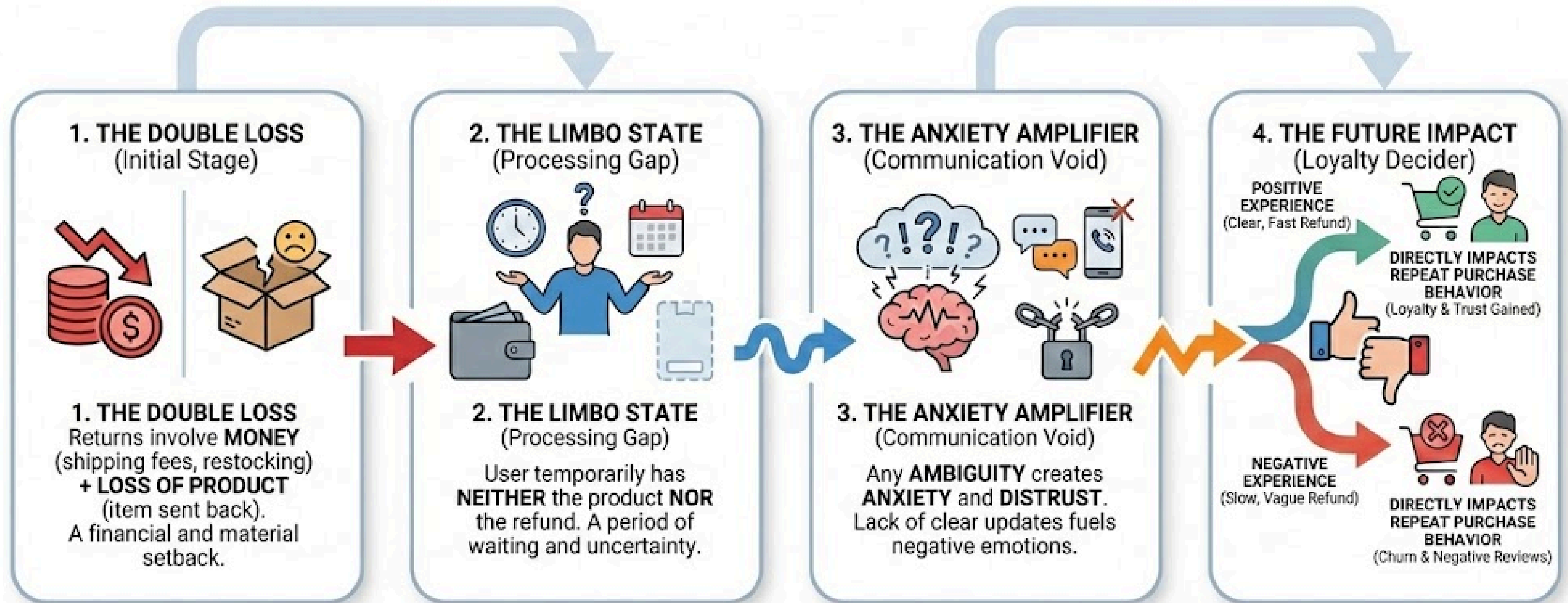


Repeated app-checking

Lack of proactive clarity drives compulsive status refresh behavior.

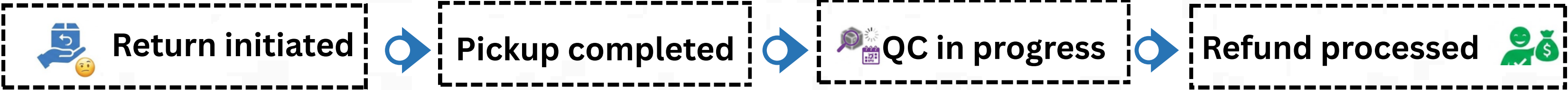
The current process functions operationally, but lacks emotional reassurance and transparency at critical touchpoints.

Why This Problem Matters?



A smooth refund doesn't delight – an uncertain refund breaks trust

User Journey Map



Thoughts

- “I hope this gets approved.”

“Will they reject it?”

“How long will my money be stuck?”
- “Okay, now what?”

“Did the system update?”

“When will QC happen?”
- “What if they say it’s damaged?”

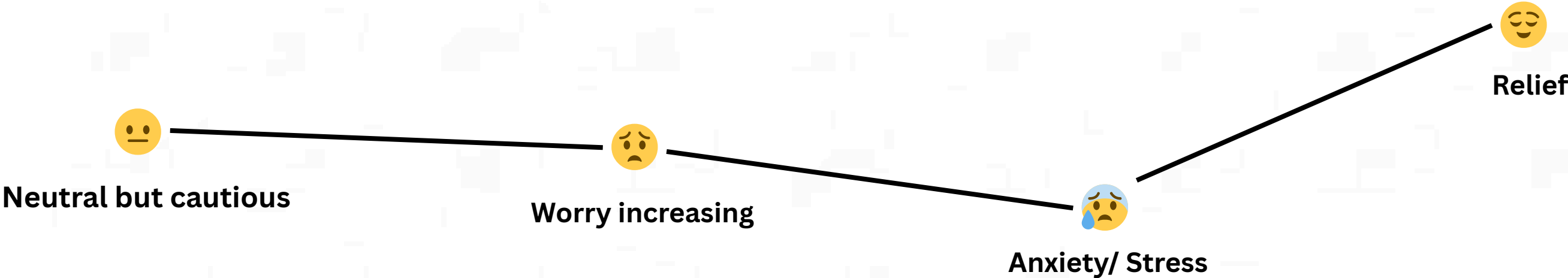
“What if they reject it unfairly?”

“Can I talk to someone?”
- “Finally!”

“How long will the bank take?”

“Will it actually reflect today?”

Sentiments



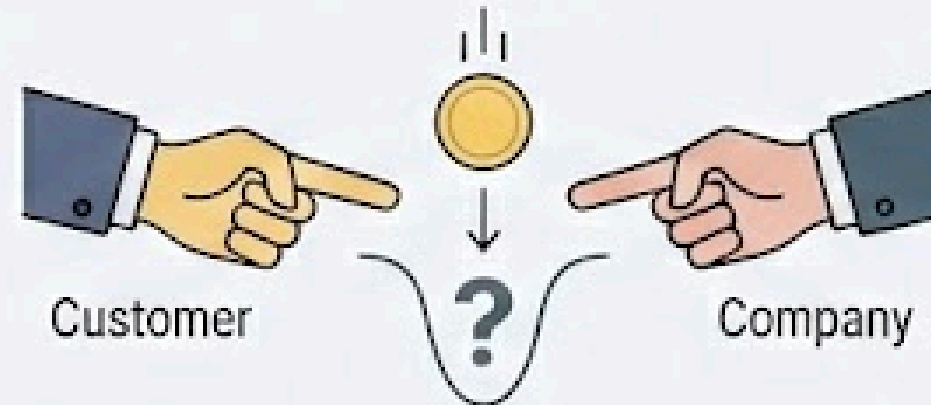
Observed Frictions Across Journeys

1. Eligibility Clarity Insufficient



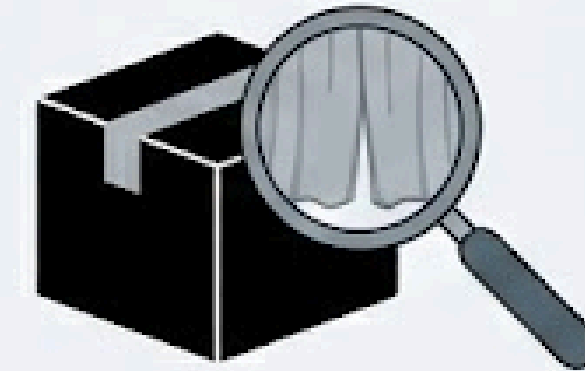
- Vague or hidden criteria.
- Users doubt qualification.

2. Refund Risk Ownership Unclear



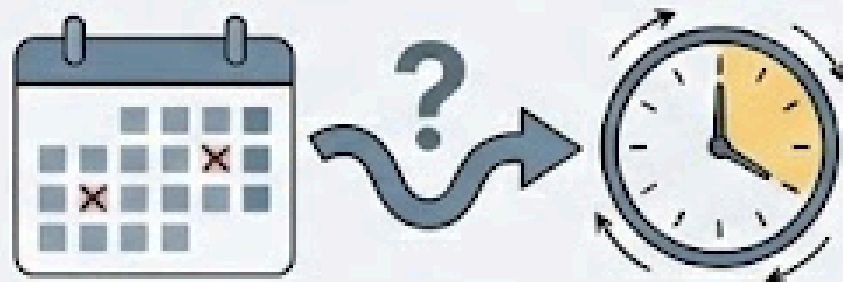
- Undefined financial risk.
- Creates anxiety.

3. QC is Invisible



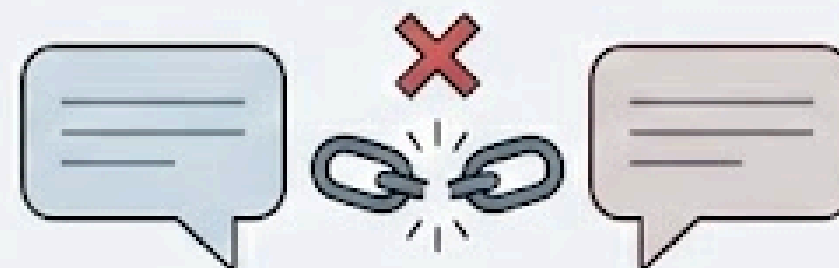
- Quality check behind closed doors.
- No visibility into process.

4. Timelines Exist but Lack Certainty



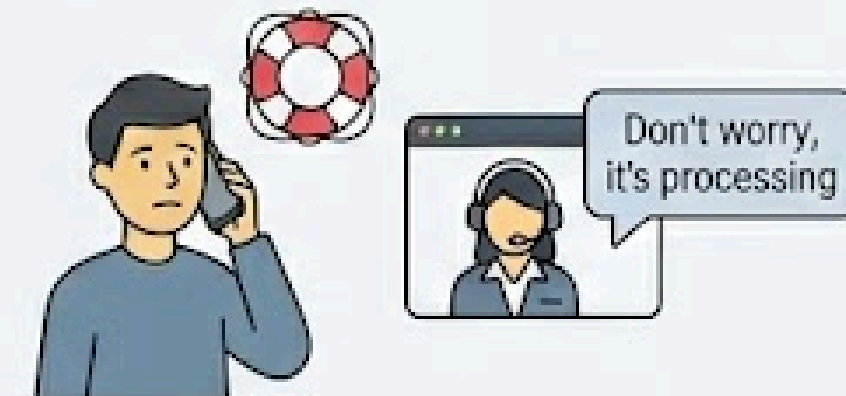
- Unreliable dates.
- 'By EOD' offers no assurance.

5. Silence Between Stages



- No proactive updates.
- Users left in dark.

6. Support Used as Reassurance Mechanism



- Used to calm users.
- Does not resolve issues.

Users seek assurance, not more status updates

Core Problem Themes

- 1. Risk ownership is ambiguous**
Users don't know when Flipkart takes responsibility

- 2. Timeline ≠ Certainty**
Time ranges don't answer "Is my refund safe?"

- 3. Closure gap**
Repeated status checking signals emotional incompleteness

- 4. Policy visibility is fragmented**
Users rely on cues, not long policy text

The refund journey shows progress, not certainty."

FUNDAMENTAL GOAL OF A REFUND SYSTEM

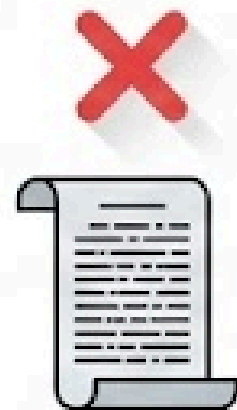
WHAT IT IS NOT



Faster
Logistics

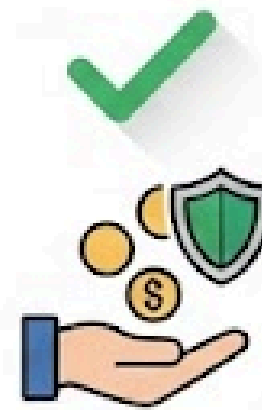


More
Notifications



Longer
Policy
Explanations

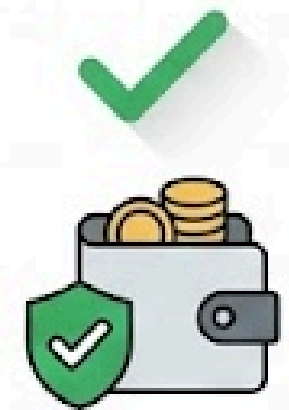
WHAT IT MUST DO



Transfer
Financial Risk
Early



Make Platform
Ownership
Explicit

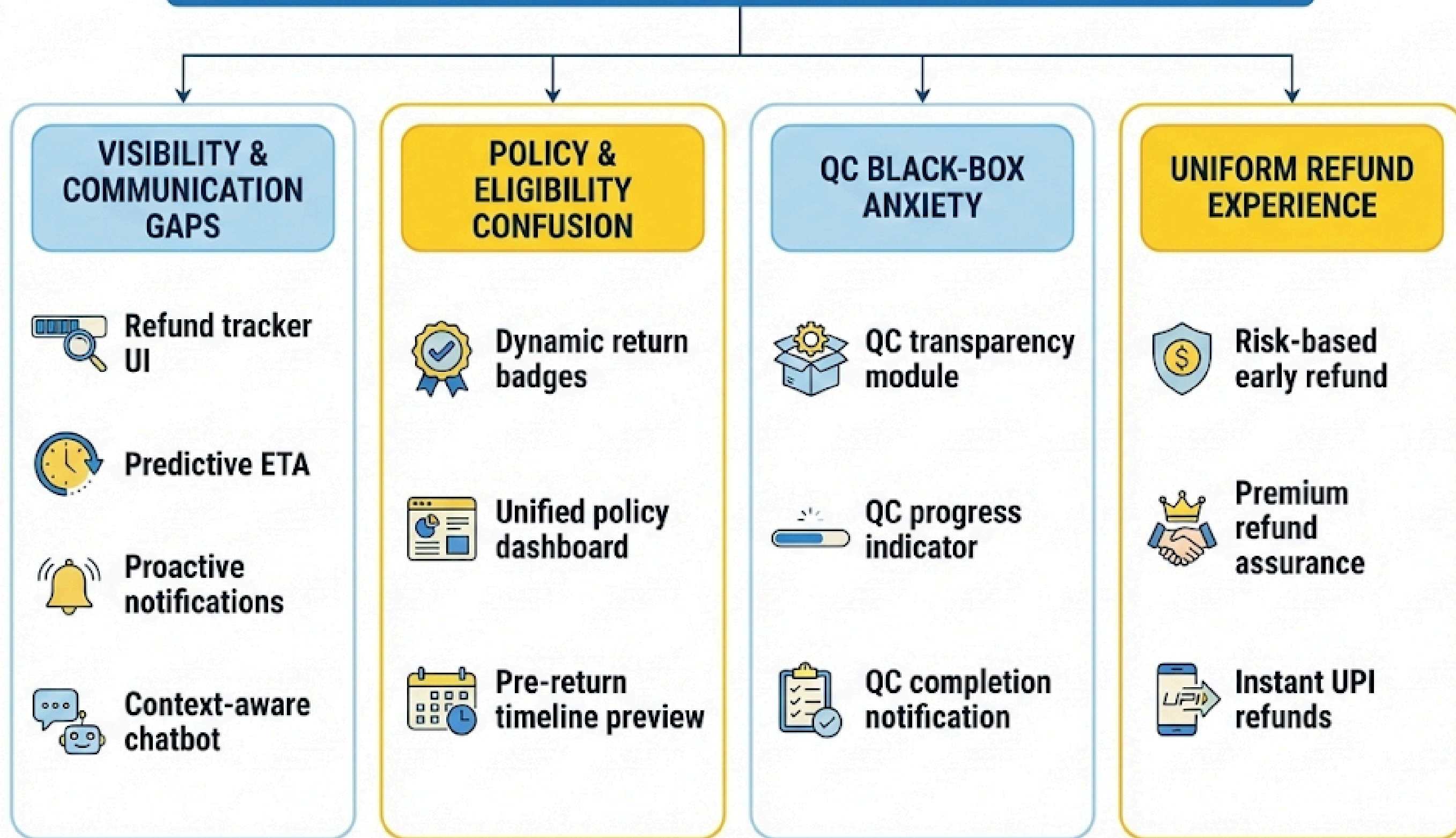


Remove
Uncertainty
About
Money Safety

Problem Statement - Users struggle to understand when their refund is truly secure during the return journey, leading to anxiety, repeated status checking, and high refund-related support tickets.

Refund anxiety is caused by uncertainty, not delay

TRUST AND TRANSPARENCY IN THE REFUND EXPERIENCE



| **Product Goal & Opportunity**

Product Goals

- Make refund risk ownership visible
- Reduce anxiety during pickup & QC
- Provide psychological closure
- Reduce refund-related support dependency

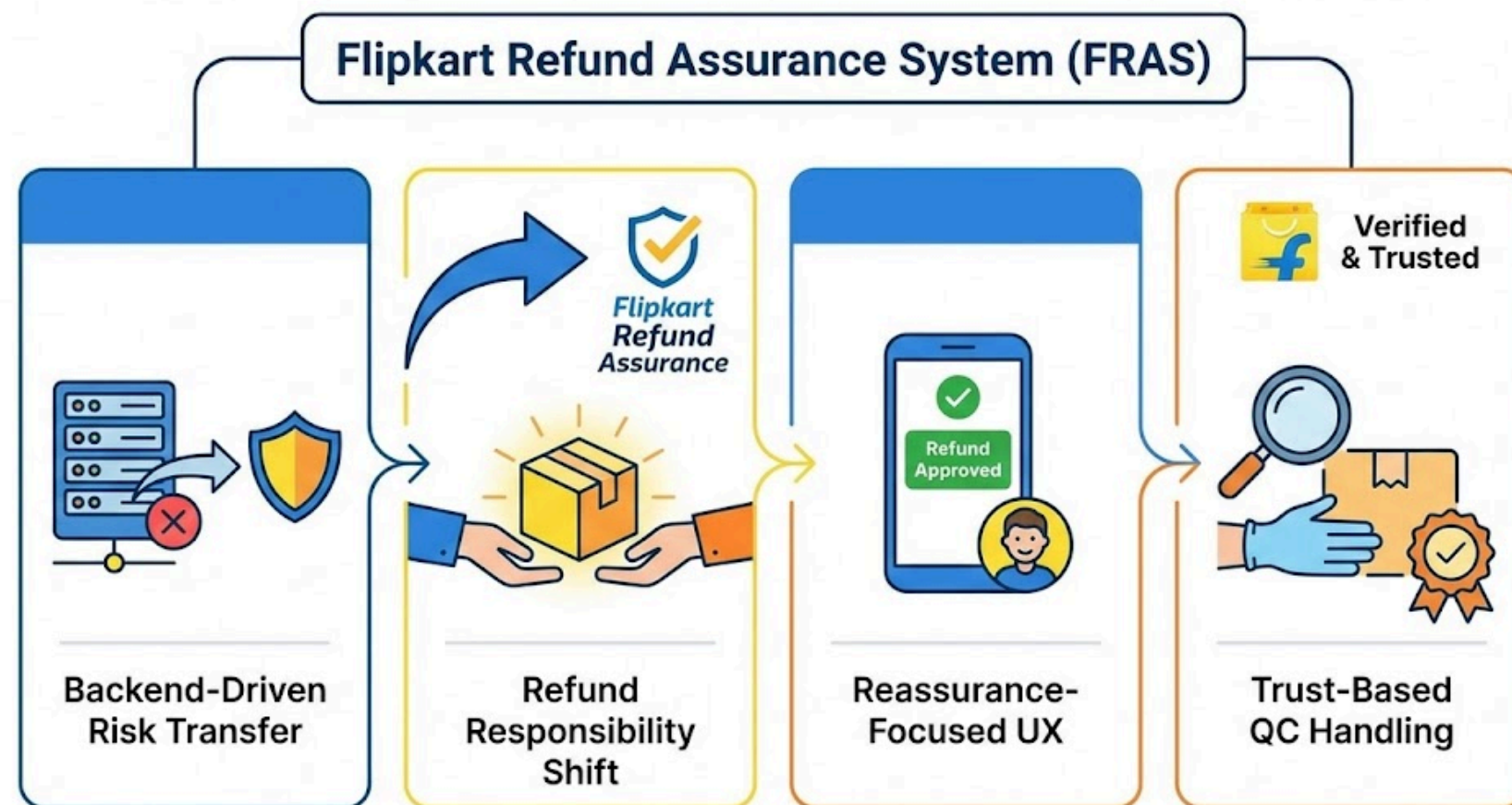
Core Opportunity Levers

- Refund risk ownership invisible
- Closure gap causes repeated checking

Solution Overview

Flipkart Refund Assurance System (FRAS)

A backend-driven refund risk transfer system that clearly communicates when refund responsibility shifts to Flipkart, supported by reassurance-focused UX and trust-based QC handling.



FRAS – Backend Foundation

Refund Guarantee Threshold Engine

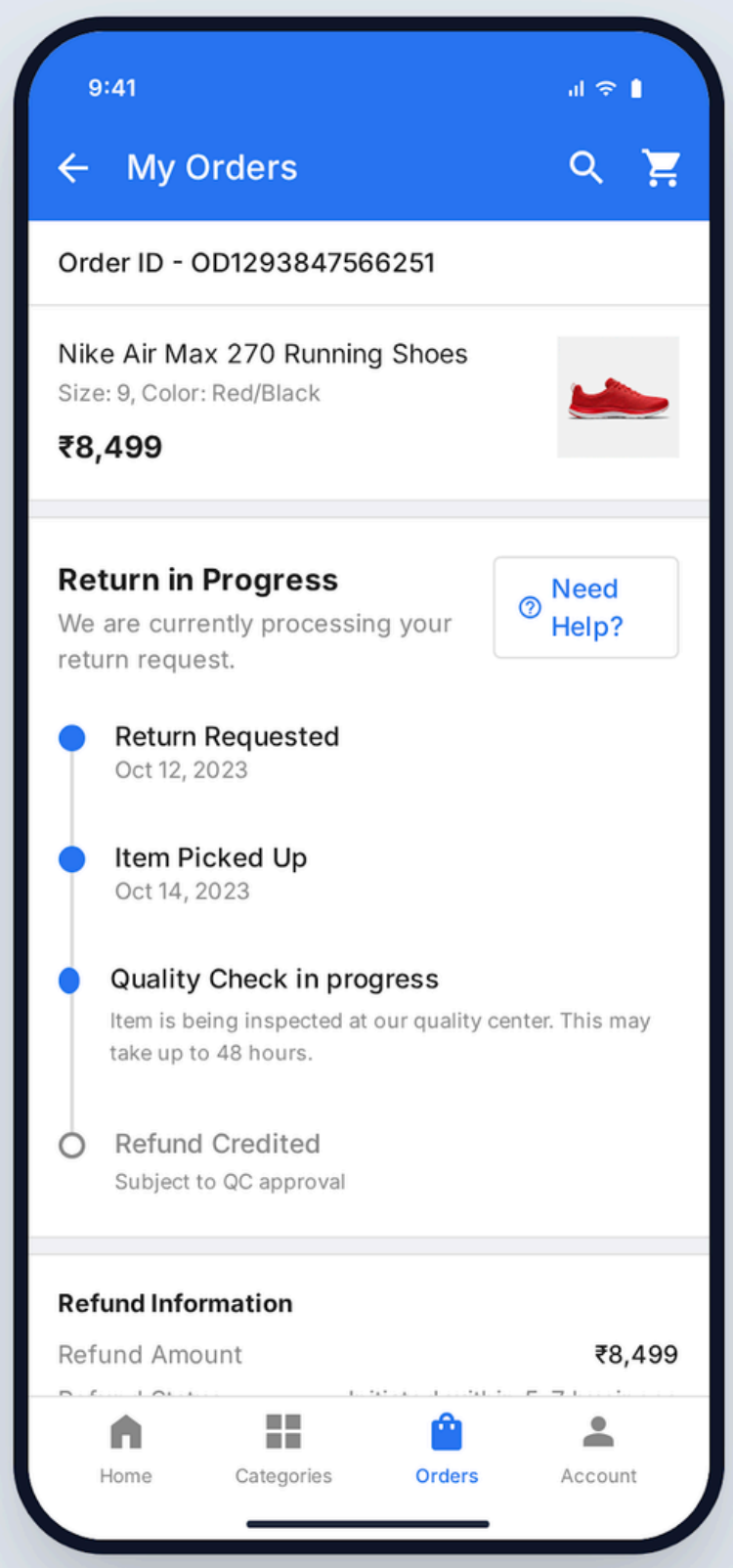
Evaluates:

- Category risk
- Seller reliability
- User trust score
- Return reason
- Fraud signals

Once confidence threshold is crossed
→ Refund risk transfers to Flipkart

This powers all user-facing guarantees.

Before: Visibility without assurance



Current Experience

Return Initiation

- Return accepted, eligibility unclear
- Generic policy text shown

After Pickup

- Item gone, money not confirmed
- No clarity on who owns refund risk

QC Stage

- “In progress” with no explanation
- No visibility into checks or ETA

Timeline Communication

- Broad time ranges shown
- No indication if refund is safe or at risk

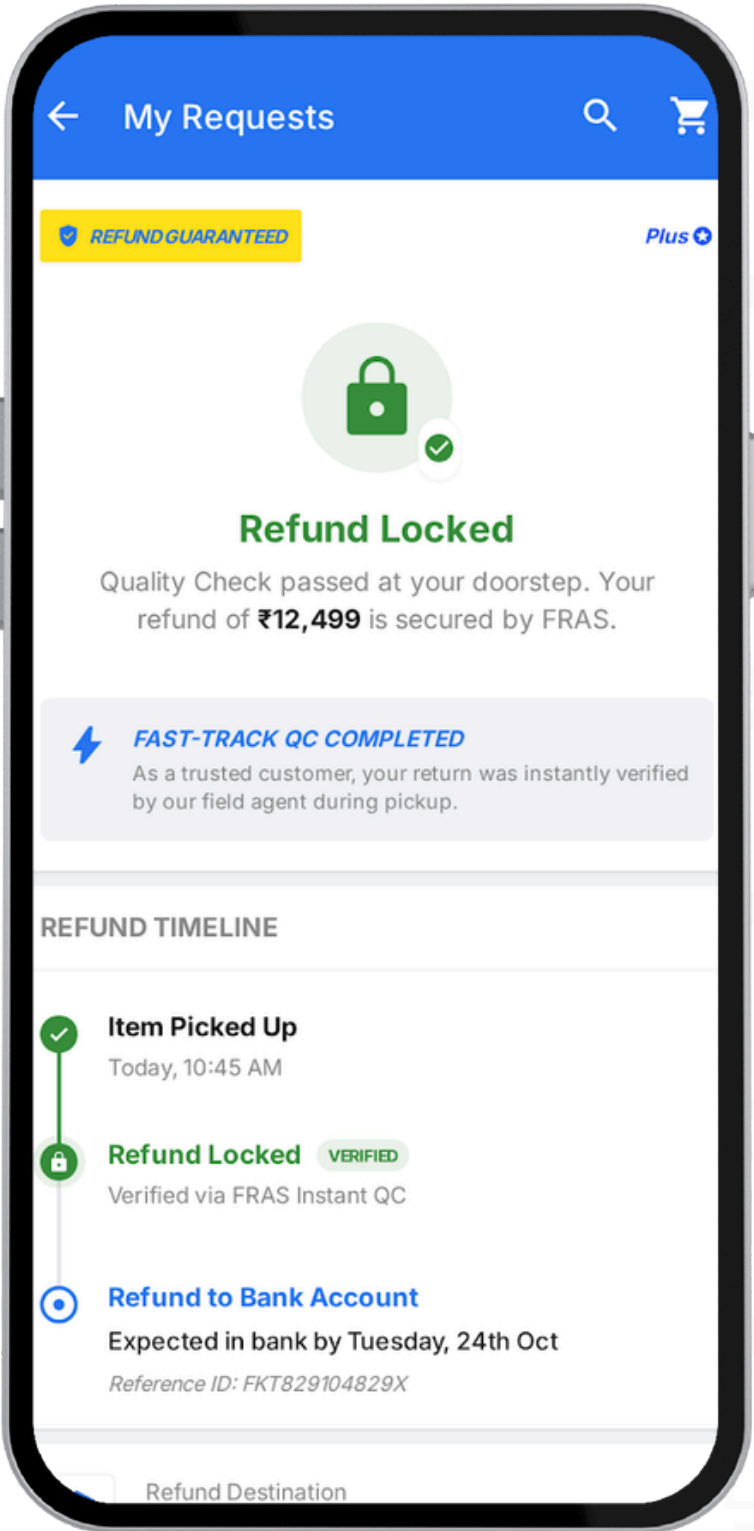
User Behavior

- Repeated status checking
- Support contacted for reassurance

User Emotion

- Anxiety, suspicion, loss of control

After: Guarantee with clarity



Current Experience

Return Initiation

- Eligibility evaluated instantly
- Refund confidence calculated

After Pickup

- Refund locked & guaranteed by Flipkart
- Ownership clearly communicated

QC Stage

- Trusted users bypass or fast-track QC
- Others see visible QC checklist + decision ETA

Timeline Communication

- “Refund guaranteed by” (Flipkart)
- “Expected credit by” (bank)

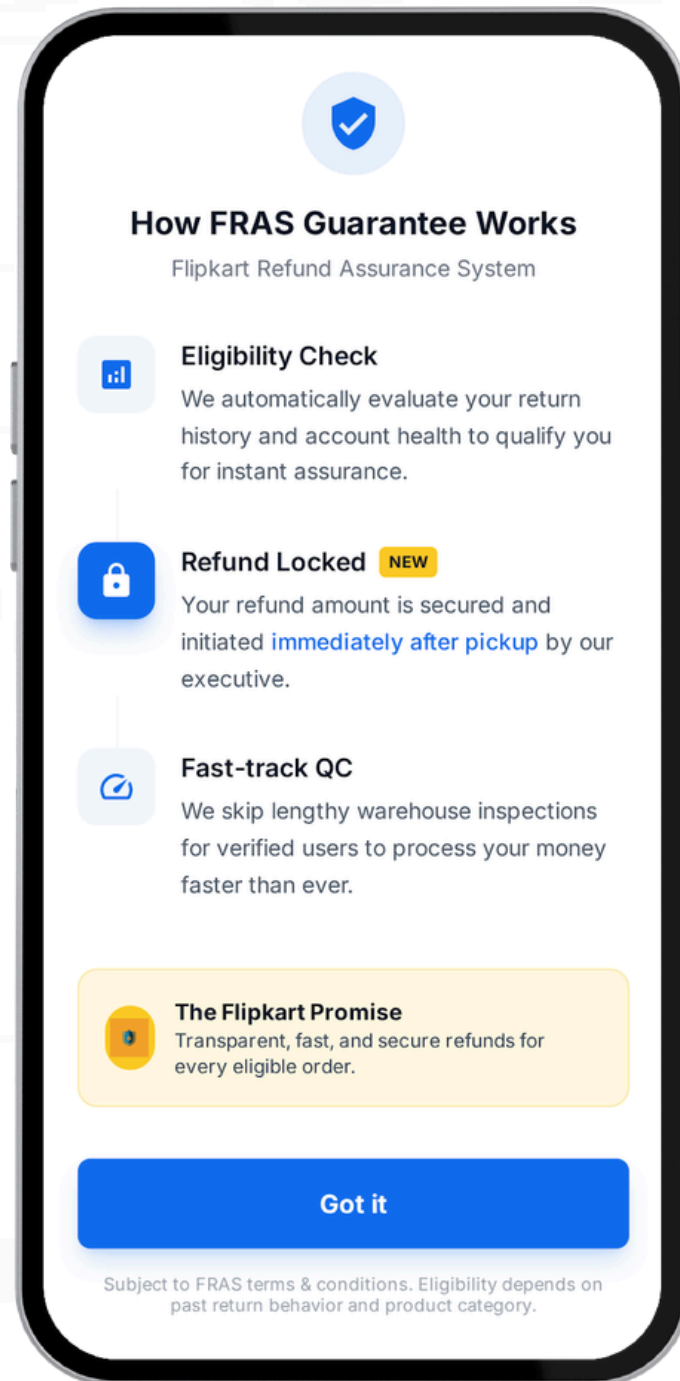
User Behavior

- Fewer refreshes
- No need to contact support

User Emotion

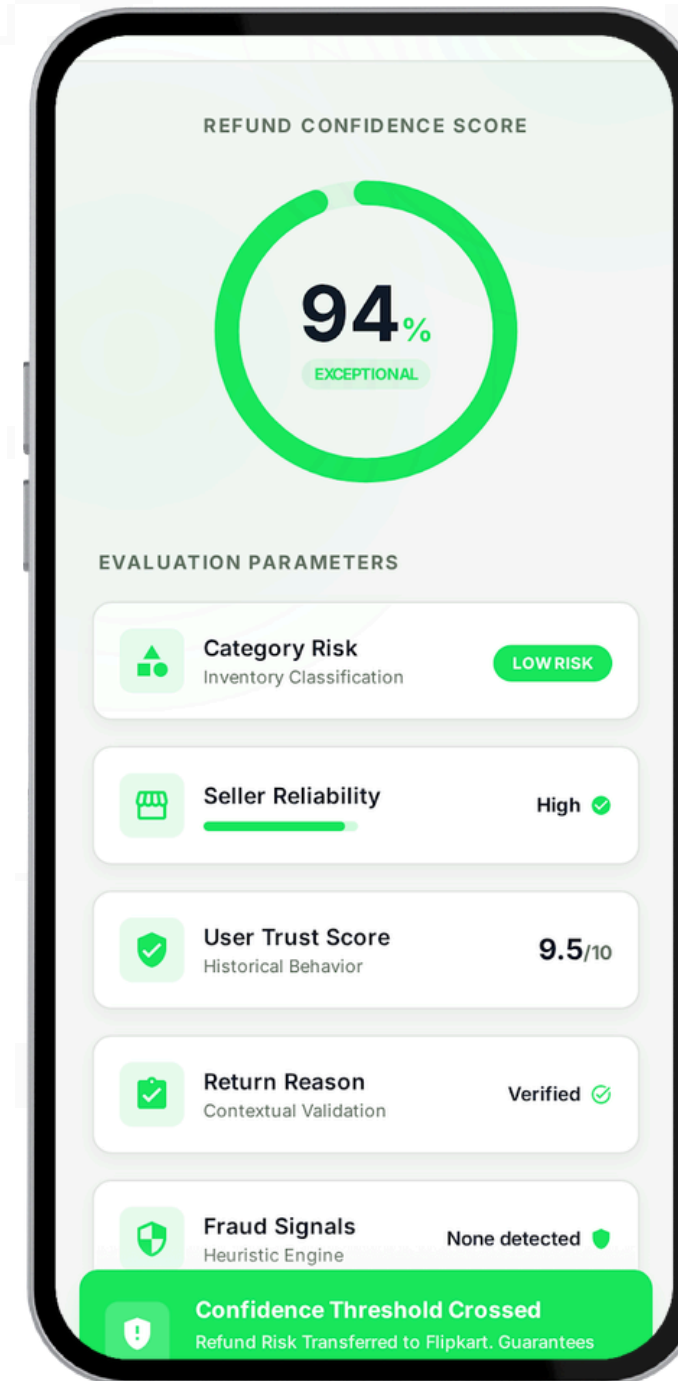
- Reassurance, control, mental closure

| Shifting Refund Systems from Speed to Certainty



Refund Assurance

- Eligibility checked upfront
- Refund amount locked at pickup
- QC runs in parallel, not as a blocker
- Platform takes early ownership of refund risk



Refund Confidence

- Single confidence score shows refund safety
- Risk factors evaluated transparently
- Fraud checks run silently
- Clear signal when platform guarantees the refund

Impact, Metrics & Summary

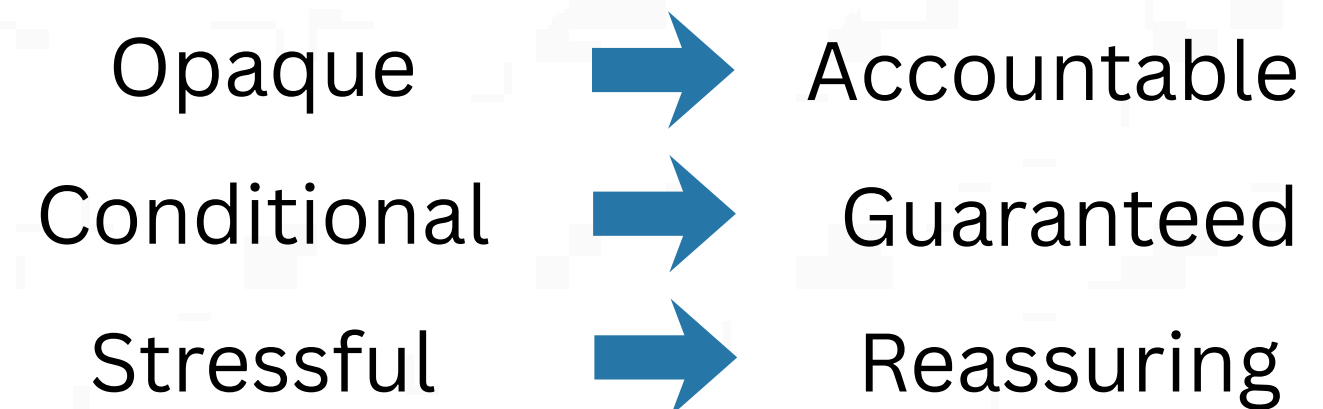
Expected Impact

- ↓ Refund-related support tickets
- ↑ Post-return repeat purchase rate
- ↑ Refund CSAT
- ↑ NPS
- ↓ App refresh

Controlled fraud exposure via threshold

Strategic Summary

FRAS transforms returns from:





THANK YOU!

